

SEO Mini Project Report

Digital Marketing for Startups

Course: CSET489 - Search Engine Optimization

Submission Date: November 26, 2025

Team Members:

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Live Website URL:

<https://startupmarketing.infinityfree.me>

1. Niche Selection

Selected Niche: Digital Marketing for Startups

Digital marketing for startups is an evergreen niche with consistently high demand. Startups worldwide need cost-effective marketing strategies to compete with established businesses, creating a large and growing audience. The competition level is moderate (Keyword Difficulty 15-30), making it ideal for a new website to rank. Monetization potential is excellent through affiliate marketing, sponsored content, consulting services, and digital product sales. The target audience includes startup founders, small business owners, entrepreneurs, and marketing professionals seeking budget-friendly growth strategies.

2. Keyword Research

Keywords were researched using Ubersuggest, SEMrush, and AnswerThePublic:

Keyword	Volume	KD	Intent	SERP Features
digital marketing for startups	8,100	18	Informational	Featured Snippet
startup marketing strategies	5,400	15	Informational	People Also Ask
SEO for startups	4,400	16	Informational	Featured Snippet
social media marketing startups	3,600	14	Informational	Video Results
low budget marketing ideas	3,100	13	Informational	People Also Ask
content marketing for startups	2,900	12	Informational	People Also Ask
startup growth hacking	2,400	19	Informational	Video Results
email marketing for startups	1,900	11	Informational	Featured Snippet

3. Keyword Selection

Primary Focus Keyword

- **digital marketing for startups** (Volume: 8,100 | KD: 18)

Rationale: High search volume with moderate difficulty, making it achievable for a new website. Directly matches our niche with informational intent.

Secondary Keywords

- **startup marketing strategies** (5,400 | KD: 15)
- **SEO for startups** (4,400 | KD: 16)
- **low budget marketing ideas** (3,100 | KD: 13)

4. Longtail and LSI Keywords

Long-tail Keywords

Keyword	Volume	Intent	Competition
how to do digital marketing for a startup	1,900	Informational	Low
best marketing channels for startups 2025	880	Informational	Low
free marketing tools for small startups	720	Commercial	Low
startup marketing plan template	1,100	Transactional	Medium

LSI Keywords

- online brand building, customer acquisition strategies
- lead generation tactics, conversion rate optimization
- marketing ROI measurement, growth marketing

5. Domain Ideas

1. startupmarketinghub.com
2. digitalmarketingforstartups.com
3. startupgrowthguide.com
4. startupmarketing.infinityfree.me (Selected)

Justification: Free subdomain selected due to budget constraints. Contains primary keyword 'startupmarketing' which is SEO-friendly.

6. Domain Registration

Domain: startupmarketing.infinityfree.me

Registrar: InfinityFree

Status: Active

Account ID: if0_40526121

7. Hosting Setup

InfinityFree shared hosting was used (free alternative to VPS):

- 5GB Storage Space
- Unlimited Bandwidth
- PHP 8.x Support
- MySQL Database
- Softaculous Auto-Installer
- cPanel Control Panel Access

8. SSL Certificate Setup

SSL Provider: ZeroSSL ECC Domain Secure Site CA

Issued On: October 15, 2025

Expires On: January 14, 2026

Status: Active (HTTPS enabled)

9. WordPress Setup

WordPress Version: 6.8.3

Installation Method: Softaculous Auto-Installer

Admin URL: <https://startupmarketing.infinityfree.me/wp-admin>

Site Title: Digital Marketing for Startups

10. WordPress Customization

Theme Installed

Astra (Free Version) - Lightweight, fast, and SEO-optimized theme

Plugins Installed

Plugin	Purpose
Rank Math SEO	On-page SEO optimization, meta tags, schema markup
LiteSpeed Cache	Page caching, optimization, faster load times
Smush	Image compression and optimization
UpdraftPlus	Complete website backup and restore

Pages Created

- **Homepage:** Hero section, service offerings, call-to-action
- **About Page:** Mission statement, team values, site purpose
- **Blog Post:** 'Digital Marketing for Startups: The Complete Guide for 2025'

11. SEO Readiness

Rank Math SEO Analysis

- **Overall SEO Score: 82/100**
- Passed Tests: 22/29
- Warnings: 1/29
- Failed Tests: 6/29

PageSpeed Insights Results

- **Performance: 90/100**
- **Accessibility: 90/100**
- **Best Practices: 100/100**
- **SEO: 100/100**
- First Contentful Paint: 0.6s
- Largest Contentful Paint: 0.6s

12. Backup

Backup Tool: UpdraftPlus v1.25.9

Backup Date: November 26, 2025, 15:42

Status: Completed Successfully

Contents: Database, Plugins, Themes, Uploads, Others

Google Drive Backup Link:

<https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/16SPFR9efEq7Cp-CM0Ag-kNeTOpSfrC18?usp=sharing>

13. Reflection and Learning Summary

This SEO mini project provided valuable hands-on experience in building an SEO-optimized website from scratch. We learned the complete workflow from niche research to deployment, understanding how keyword research directly influences content strategy. Implementing Rank Math taught us on-page SEO fundamentals including meta tag optimization, focus keyword usage, and content structure. The hosting setup, though different from a traditional VPS due to budget constraints, demonstrated that effective SEO can be achieved with free resources. PageSpeed optimization showed us the importance of performance in user experience and rankings. The most significant learning was understanding how all SEO elements work together to create a cohesive, search-engine-friendly website. This project has prepared us to apply these skills in real-world digital marketing scenarios.

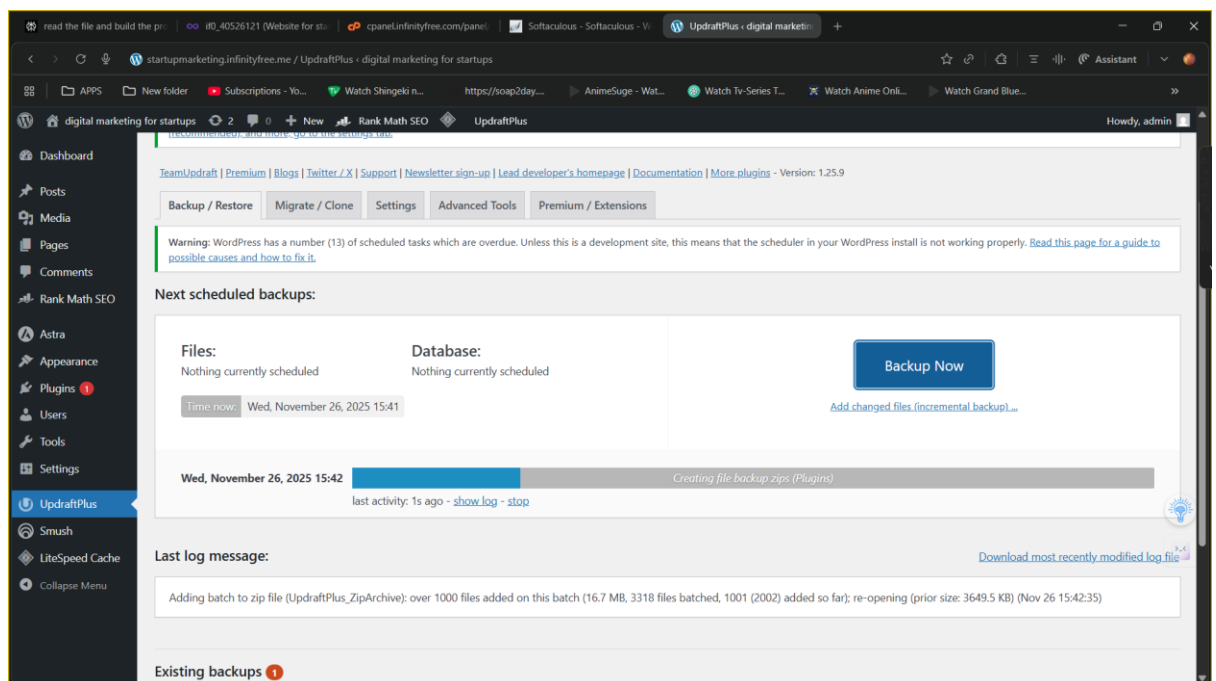
14. Live Website URL

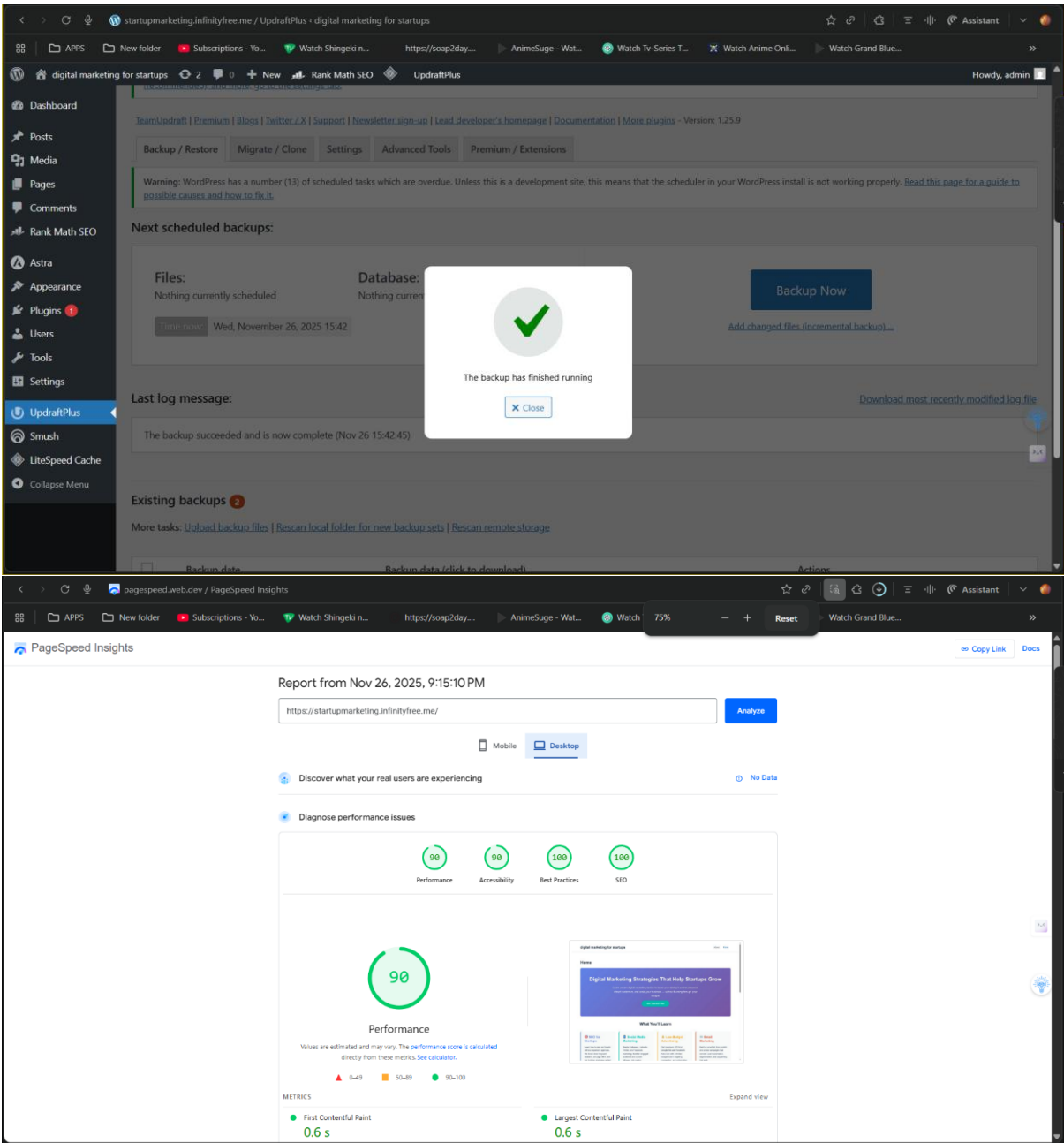
<https://startupmarketing.infinityfree.me>

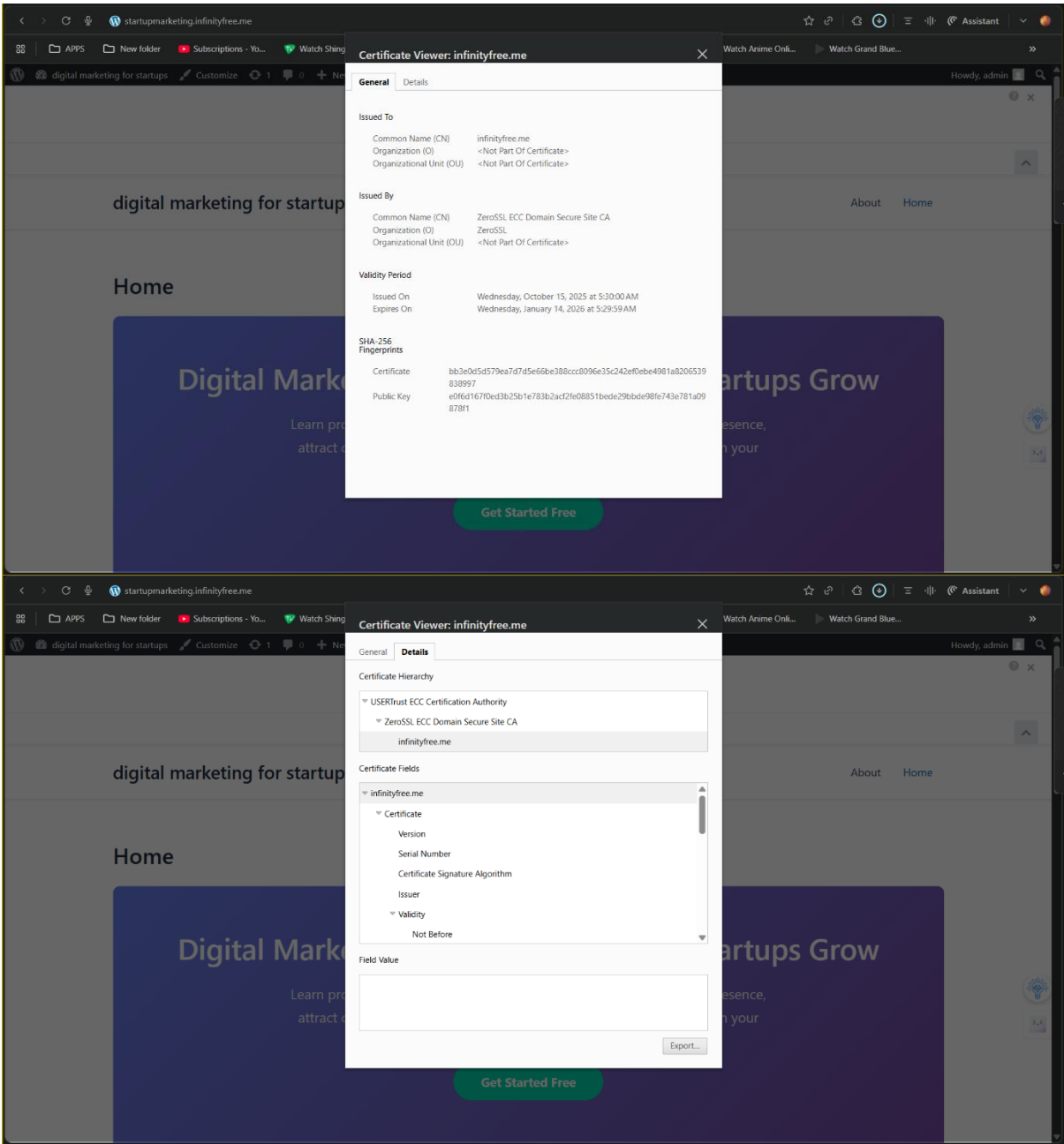
Appendix: Screenshots

The following screenshots are attached as supporting evidence:

1. InfinityFree Dashboard - Domain Registration
2. WordPress Dashboard
3. Installed Plugins Page (All 4 Required Plugins)
4. Astra Theme Activated
5. Homepage (Live Site)
6. About Page (Live Site)
7. Blog Post Published
8. Rank Math SEO Analysis (82/100)
9. PageSpeed Insights Results (90/90/100/100)
10. SSL Certificate Details (ZeroSSL)
11. UpdraftPlus Backup Complete
12. Existing Backups List







The image displays two screenshots of web interfaces. The top screenshot shows the InfinityFree account management page for the account 'if0_40526121' (Website for startupmarketing.infinityfree.me). The page includes a navigation bar with links like Home, Profile, Hosting Accounts, Domains, SSL Certificates, Website Builder, and Help. A sidebar on the left lists 'Account Options' such as Home, Upgrade to Premium Hosting, Account Statistics, FTP Details, MySQL Databases, and Deactivation History. The main content area features buttons for 'Control Panel', 'File Manager', 'Website Builder', and 'Script Installer'. It also displays a table of domains with one entry: 'startupmarketing.infinityfree.me' with a 'Manage' button. To the right, 'Account Details' are shown, including Username (if0_40526121), Password (masked), Status (Active), and Label (Website for startupmarketing.infinityfree.me). A warning message at the top states: 'It can take up to 72 hours for new domains to be accessible everywhere! This is caused by DNS caching, which InfinityFree cannot control, but there are some workarounds you can try. Learn more.'

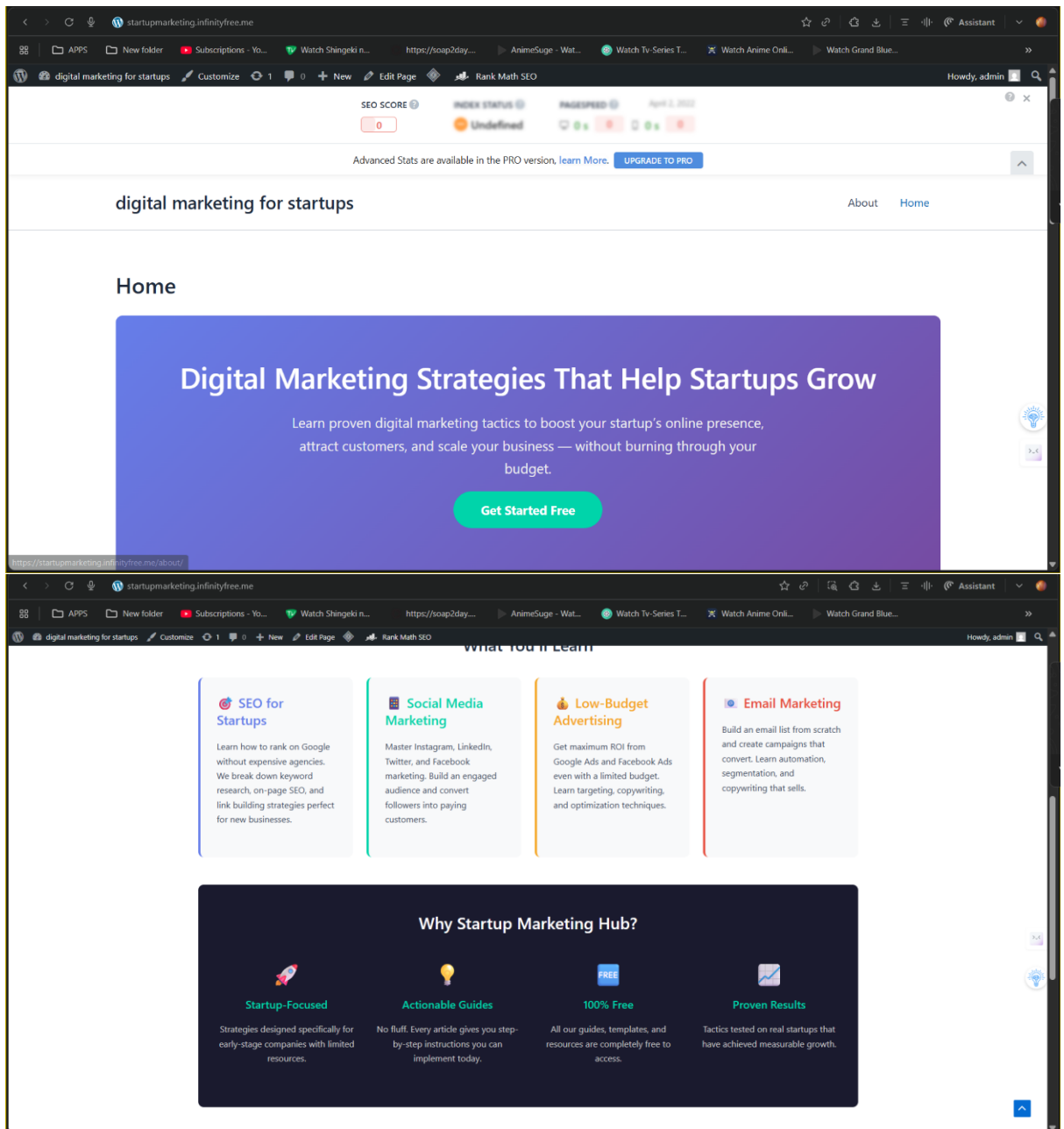
The bottom screenshot shows the WordPress dashboard for 'startupmarketing.infinityfree.me'. The dashboard includes a sidebar with links to Home, Updates, Posts, Media, Pages, Comments, Rank Math SEO, Astra, Appearance, Plugins, Users, Tools, Settings, UpdraftPlus, Smush, LiteSpeed Cache, and Collapse Menu. The main content area features a 'WordPress 6.8.3 is available! Please update now.' notification. Below this is a 'Rank Math Overview' section with analytics for the last 30 days, showing Total Impressions (0), Total Clicks (0), Total Keywords (0), and Average Position (0). There is also a 'Quick Draft' section with fields for Title and Content, and a 'WordPress Events and News' section with a message about upcoming events.

The screenshot displays a WordPress dashboard for a user named 'Howdy, admin'. The browser address bar shows 'startupmarketing.infinityfree.me / Dashboard - digital marketing for startups'. The dashboard includes a sidebar with navigation links for Dashboard, Home, Updates, Posts, Media, Pages, Comments, Rank Math SEO, Astra, Appearance, Plugins, Users, Tools, Settings, UpdraftPlus, Smush, LiteSpeed Cache, and Collapse Menu.

The main content area features a notification for 'WordPress 6.8.3 is available! Please update now.' Below this is a 'Dashboard' section with a message from 'Smush' asking for feedback. The 'Activity' widget shows a recent post titled 'Digital Marketing for Startups: The Complete Guide for 2025'. The 'Site Health Status' widget shows 'Rank Math Overview' and 'At a Glance'. The 'WordPress Events and News' widget lists upcoming events and updates, including 'WordPress 6.9 Release Candidate 3' and 'WordPress 6.9 Release Candidate 2'. A 'Quick Draft' button is also visible.

The 'Plugins' section is shown below, listing installed plugins with their descriptions and update status:

Plugin	Description	Automatic Updates
☐ Akismet Anti-spam: Spam Protection	Used by millions, Akismet is quite possibly the best way in the world to protect your blog from spam. It keeps your site protected even while you sleep. To get started, just go to your Akismet Settings page to set up your API key. Version 5.5 By Automattic - Anti-spam Team View details	Enable auto-updates
☐ Hello Dolly	This is not just a plugin, it symbolizes the hope and enthusiasm of an entire generation summed up in two words sung most famously by Louis Armstrong: Hello, Dolly. When activated you will randomly see a lyric from Hello, Dolly in the upper right of your admin screen on every page. Version 1.7.2 By Matt Mullenweg View details	Enable auto-updates
☐ LiteSpeed Cache	High-performance page caching and site optimization from LiteSpeed Version 7.6.2 By LiteSpeed Technologies View details	Enable auto-updates
☐ Rank Math SEO	Rank Math SEO is the Best WordPress SEO plugin with the features of many SEO and AI SEO tools in a single package to help multiply your SEO traffic. Version 1.0.258 By Rank Math SEO View details Getting Started Documentation	Disable auto-updates
☐ Smush	Reduce image file sizes, improve performance and boost your SEO using the free WPMU DEV WordPress Smush API . Version 3.22.3 By WPMU DEV View details Rate Smush Support Roadmap ★★★★★	Enable auto-updates
☐ UpdraftPlus - Backup/Restore	Backup and restore: take backups locally, or backup to Amazon S3, Dropbox, Google Drive, Rackspace, (S)FTP, WebDAV & email, on automatic schedules. Version 1.25.9 By TeamUpdraft, DavidAnderson View details	Enable auto-updates



The screenshot displays a web browser window with two tabs. The active tab is 'startupmarketing.infinifree.me / About', showing a website titled 'digital marketing for startups'. The website has a navigation bar with 'About' and 'Home' links. The main content area includes sections for 'About', 'About Startup Marketing Hub' (with the tagline 'Helping startups grow through smart digital marketing strategies'), 'Our Mission', 'What We Offer' (listing services like SEO Guides, Social Media Strategies, Paid Advertising Tips, Content Marketing, Email Marketing, and Analytics & Tracking), and 'Why We Started This Site'.

The second tab is the WordPress admin dashboard for 'Rank Math SEO'. The dashboard shows a notification that a backup succeeded. Below this, there is a table of 'Existing backups' with columns for 'Backup date', 'Backup data (click to download)', and 'Actions'. The table lists two backups from 'Nov 26, 2025 15:42'. The 'Backup data' column contains links for 'Database', 'Plugins', 'Themes', 'Uploads', and 'Others'. The 'Actions' column contains 'Restore', 'Delete', and 'View Log' buttons. Below the table, there are links for 'Upload backup files', 'Rescan local folder for new backup sets', and 'Rescan remote storage'. The dashboard also features a sidebar with various menu items like 'Dashboard', 'Posts', 'Media', 'Pages', 'Comments', 'Rank Math SEO', 'Astra', 'Customize', 'Site Builder', 'Spectra', 'Appearance', 'Plugins', 'Users', 'Tools', 'Settings', 'UpdraftPlus', 'Smush', and 'LiteSpeed Cache'. The main content area of the dashboard includes a 'Welcome Admin' message, a 'Getting Started with Astra' section, a 'Quick Settings' section with links to customize various site elements, and a 'Do more with Astra Pro Modules' section listing various premium features like 'Colors & Background', 'Typography', 'Spacing', 'Blog Pro', 'Sticky Header', 'Site Layouts', 'Nav Menu', and 'Site Builder'. A 'Quick Access' section at the bottom right provides links to 'VIP Priority Support', 'Help Center', and 'Join the Community'.

The screenshot shows a presentation slide with a light blue background and a dark blue sidebar on the right. The slide content is as follows:

- Demographics (age, location, income)
- Pain points and challenges
- Goals and aspirations
- Where they spend time online
- How they make purchasing decisions

Step 2: Set SMART Marketing Goals

Your goals should be Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound. Examples:

- Generate 500 website visitors per month within 90 days
- Build an email list of 1,000 subscribers in 6 months
- Achieve 50 product signups per month by Q3

Step 3: Choose Your Marketing Channels

Don't try to be everywhere. Start with 2-3 channels where your audience is most active:

- **B2B Startups:** LinkedIn, SEO, Email Marketing
- **B2C Startups:** Instagram, Facebook, Influencer Marketing
- **SaaS Startups:** Content Marketing, SEO, PPC
- **Local Startups:** Google My Business, Local SEO, Facebook

SEO Basics for Startup Websites

Search Engine Optimization (SEO) is one of the most powerful **digital marketing strategies for startups** because it delivers free, consistent traffic over time.

The sidebar on the right contains several small, circular icons: a lightbulb, a magnifying glass, a document, and a checkmark.

--- End of Report ---